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What are SSPs and Ad techs roles towards Sustainable Programmatic Supply Path?

As advertisers increasingly prioritize sustainability in their marketing campaigns on the demand side, DSPs are implementing threshold limits to encourage a more environmentally friendly programmatic supply chain. What role does the supply path play in driving this movement towards greener practices?

In an era defined by a growing awareness of environmental concerns and the urgent need for sustainable practices, the world of digital advertising has come under scrutiny. The concept of "Green Programmatic" or "Sustainable Media" has emerged as a response to the industry's environmental impact. It calls for a shift towards more eco-friendly and sustainable advertising practices.

This evolution involves various stakeholders in the demand-side (Advertisers and DSPs), as well as in the supply-side: including Supply-Side Platforms (SSPs), and Ad tech companies, each playing a crucial role in reducing the carbon footprint of digital advertising.

In this article, we delve into the specific contributions and responsibilities of these key players towards achieving a sustainable and more environmentally conscious programmatic advertising landscape.

Supply-Side Platforms (SSPs) have traditionally acted as intermediaries connecting publishers and advertisers.

SSPs Can Lead the Way in Green SPO

SSPs play a crucial role in the digital advertising ecosystem, and they can certainly lead the way in making Supply Path Optimization (SPO) more environmentally friendly and sustainable. SPO involves

energy consumption, data center usage, and overall carbon footprint. Here are some ways SSPs can lead the way in green SPO:

Reducing Traffic Cost, Increasing Traffic Quality

The statistics show that more than 95% of bid requests sent from SSPs to DSPs can be categorized as digital waste. Yeah! It is quite striking. Wasteful requests refer to network requests that do not deliver significant value, such as those with no response, no bid, or bids falling below the operating cost.

It highlights the inefficiencies and resource consumption within the digital advertising ecosystem, emphasizing the need for more precise targeting, improved data quality, and better optimization practices to reduce this substantial waste.

Data centers are energy-intensive operations. SSPs can invest in more energy-efficient servers or partner with data center providers that prioritize sustainability. This includes using renewable energy sources and implementing energy-efficient technologies. Another solution is regarding the quality of network traffic, which can be vastly optimized by reducing 60% of waste requests. And it results in higher overall bid rates and traded volume, higher profitability and a significant reduction in the server cost.

The quality of the traffic is key, since DSP threshold limits bid requests. By the way, you may want to explore more about [what is QPS \(query per second\) optimization](#) to understand in details how to optimize QPS limits.

Striking a delicate balance between reducing bid requests and enhancing fill rates, win rates, and profitability is crucial for SSPs. To increase these limits, SSPs must deliver high-quality traffic to their partners, steering clear of digital waste caused by empty auctions or invaluable bid requests. To cultivate stronger relationships with their SSP partners, these platforms are now adopting innovative traffic shaping solutions. By doing so, they gain better bargaining power to negotiate limit increases and, in turn, optimize their overall performance.

Advanced User Profiling

To optimize traffic while maintaining profitability, effective matchmaking is essential. Traffic shaping technologies play a crucial role in this process, swiftly matching trillions of ad requests with suitable demand partners in microseconds. These technologies analyze real-time bidding data, enriched with insights from partners, to determine the suitability of user profiles before proceeding to the auction. If the location, time of day, or user profile suggests a low-value request that doesn't justify QPS limits, the bid request is excluded from the auction.

Achieving this efficiency involves reducing industry-wide traffic by at least 50%, leveraging machine learning and predictive methods to assess the value of domains and users, and determining each request value (using a sophisticated prediction model)

"Publishers can easily cut 40% of traffic without harming income, whereas SSPs can decrease 50 to 60% of traffic while increasing revenue! by investing in quality prediction algorithms." According to Nils Lind.

SSPs, and their partners can now contribute to the industry's journey towards ad net zero. For example, publishers can remove resellers from their ads.txt file and work with direct demand, as well as manually map out SSPs from browsers/countries where they do not operate.

Ad Buyers can contribute by devoting a more considerable portion of their budgets to lower-carbon creative, such as standard IAB display units, and by directing their budgets to greener DSPs and SSPs. DSPs and advertisers must also identify spammy partners and reward SSP owners who prioritize sustainability.

Ad techs traffic shaping solutions for the supply-side

Ad tech is ultimately an enabler - a set of technologies that help brands communicate their marketing messages to a relevant audience. With that in mind, there are key ways it can influence behavior:

By helping brands promote ethical products and services and successfully grow their businesses.

- Consumer spend on ethical products has grown significantly faster in the past decade than overall consumer spend. Because of this, many brands now produce products and services that provide people with more sustainable consumer options. This might be an electric vehicle, a meat-free food option, sustainably sourced clothing, or a green financial product. For those brands to grow successfully, they need to reach an audience most likely to be interested.
- In the same way, a clothing brand might choose to reach fashion-conscious consumers by appearing in Vogue, a brand with a sustainable product message must reach ethically-conscious consumers. Advertising can influence people towards more sustainable products, and ad tech can help brands reach the audience that is most likely to engage.

By supporting publishers whose content inspires and educates people to live more sustainably.

- The increasing consumer interest in sustainability is reflected in the growth of digital publishers

how people can make sustainable lifestyle choices, to mindbodygreen.com, writing about how people can benefit both their own health and the planet around them.

- However, many emerging publishers do not receive any spending from major media agencies or brands. Ad tech is vital in ensuring these types of publishers get their fair share of ad dollars. This revenue helps them grow and create more content, influencing mass behavior change.

Discover how GumGum achieved a 30% QPS on average reduction using Traffic Shaping. Read the full story



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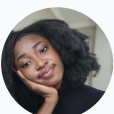
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Check out the associated AY solution

Traffic Shaping

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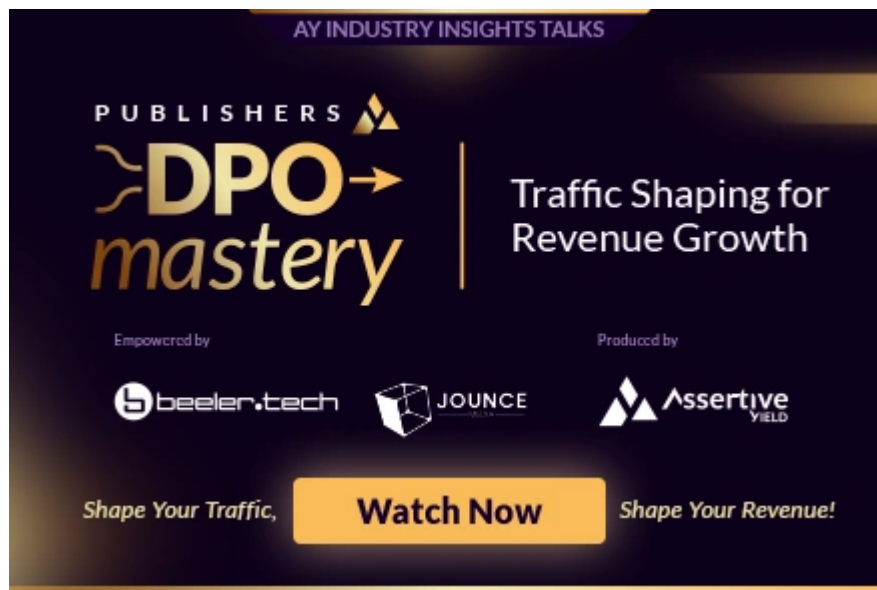
Frequently asked questions

What is Supply Path Optimization (SPO)?



What are the best traffic shaping solutions for publishers and SSPs?





DPO Mastery: Traffic Shaping for Revenue Growth

This exclusive four-episode series brings together industry experts Chris Kane, Nils Lind, and Rob Beeler to tackle the biggest challenges and opportunities for Digital Publishers, SSPs, and DSPs.

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